



HOW TO MAKE RASPBERRY JAM

Makes 2 small jars

Ingredients

- * 650g (1½lb) raspberries (preferably not overripe)
- * Juice of ½ lemon
- * 75g (2½oz) granulated sugar

Equipment

- * Preserving pan or large, heavy-based saucepan
- * Large wooden spoon
- * Sterilized wide-mouthed jam funnel (optional)
- * Ladle
- * Sterilized jars with metal lids or cellophane covers and elastic bands
- * Skimmer or slotted spoon (optional)
- * Discs of waxed paper



1 Put a few small saucers in the fridge to chill. Place the fruit in a preserving pan or large heavy-based saucepan. Add the lemon juice and 150ml (5fl oz) of water. The lemon juice provides extra acid, which is vital for setting, as raspberries tend to be low in acid.



2 Simmer the fruit gently for 3–5 minutes to soften and release its juices. Then add the sugar and stir it in over a gentle heat. Once it has all dissolved, turn the heat to high. Remember sugar inhibits the release of pectin and toughens the skins of fruits, so always add it to the pan after the fruit has softened sufficiently.



3 Bring the jam to a rolling boil for 5–10 minutes or until the setting point is reached. Start testing for the setting point when the bubbles in the jam become large and start “plopping”.